

Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **India faces a "two-and-a-half-front" challenge. The collusion between Pakistan and China is 100 per cent in the virtual domain**
- **Accelerating India's 5th-gen fighter jet project is urgently required. Until then, India might need to buy off-the-shelf fighters**
- **Wartime disruptions in supply chains and shifting alliances highlight the risks of military dependence on foreign suppliers**

ADM. DINESH K. TRIPATHI

Chief of the Naval Staff

"It's not just about being Aatmanirbhar, but how quickly we achieve it. We must accelerate the pace of technology induction to bolster our naval capabilities"

He also emphasised the need to accelerate the development of India's fifth-generation fighter aircraft, the Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA). However, he acknowledged that India might have to procure off-the-shelf fighter jets with indigenous modifications until then.

Navy chief Adm. Dinesh Kumar Tripathi drew lessons from the Russia-Ukraine war, overturning the belief that modern conflicts would be short and decisive. He noted how technological adaptation and external support allowed Ukraine to challenge a superior adversary. He stressed that supply chain disruptions and shifting geopolitical alliances highlight the dangers of military dependence on foreign suppliers. Urging faster implementation of *aatmanirbharta* (self-reliance), he called for rapid technological advancements, particularly in naval capabilities, for India's strategic maritime independence. India's military leadership delivered a clear message: the country faces security threats and technological gaps, and self-reliance in defence manufacturing is the need of the hour. ■

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